

ANDRES ARBELAEZ

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Designer, Design Engineer, and Founder with 7+ years of experience spanning AI-native product design, design systems, and cross-platform application development. Proven track record of end-to-end design leadership in cross-functional environments at Meta, IDEO CoLab, and as a startup and nonprofit founder.

Experienced in 0→1 product development, interaction design for agentic and AI-powered experiences, and translating ambiguous, unstructured problems into user-centered design solutions.

Passionate about designing equitable, accessible experiences at the intersection of AI capabilities and human needs.

CORE SKILLS

Design Engineering · Product Design · UX Design · Visual Design · Design Systems · AI-Native & Agentic Product Design · 0→1 Product Development · Figma · Prototyping · User Research · Cross-functional Collaboration · Product Strategy · Product Thinking · Storytelling · Design Leadership · React · TypeScript · Frontend Development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Confidant — Remote

November 2025 – Present

Founder, Design Engineer

- Designed and shipped an open-source, privacy-first AI mental health companion from 0→1 as a solo design engineer, now available at [confidant.one](#)
- Architected a cross-platform desktop application with fully local LLM inference and RAG, ensuring complete data privacy with no server-side data storage
- Led end-to-end product development spanning interaction design, visual design, design system architecture, and frontend engineering (React, TypeScript)
- Built a comprehensive design system from scratch including tokens, typography, component library, and accessibility guidelines

After School Records — Bogotá, Colombia

January 2022 – Present

Co-Founder, Design Engineer, Producer, Artist

- Co-founded an independent web3 music label integrating on-chain technology for music distribution, creator ownership, and fan engagement
- Designed and developed the label's full digital product experience and brand identity, including smart contract architecture for community access tokens (Solidity, Vercel)

Meta (Facebook) — Menlo Park, CA

July 2019 – July 2021

Product Designer

- Collaborated with UX Researchers, Product Managers, and Engineers to design and ship data visualization tools for Lift Testing, an Ads Manager product used by Meta's largest enterprise advertising clients
- Led design of a new design system for the Ads Manager platform, improving consistency and scalability across multiple product surfaces
- Translated complex advertising performance data into clear, intuitive user experiences, balancing business requirements with user-centered design principles

IDEO — Cambridge, MA

January 2019 – April 2019

CoLab Design Fellow

- Proposed and prototyped emerging technologies to advance IDEO's portfolio of partner organizations, applying participatory design and rapid prototyping methodologies
- Translated ambiguous, unstructured research problems into actionable product concepts and functional prototypes

Meta (Instagram) — Menlo Park, CA

May 2017 – August 2017

Software Engineering Intern

- Developed front-end iOS features using React and Objective-C on the Instagram Ads Creation and Management team
- Collaborated with designers and content strategists to improve internationalization of Instagram's in-app Promote/Boost flow

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

University of Maryland — College Park, MD

August 2018 – May 2019

Course Instructor

- Developed and taught curriculum for "IDEA258Z: Introduction to Product Design," a student-initiated course at the University of Maryland
- Co-instructed 15 students in product design fundamentals including user research, interaction design, visual design, and prototyping

EDUCATION

University of Maryland — College Park, MD

2015 – 2019

B.S., Human-Centered Product Design

- Proposed and completed an Individual Studies degree combining Computer Science, Psychology, and Arts — developing a holistic, multidisciplinary approach to product design

PROJECTS

Interfaces —

Ongoing

Independent Research Project

- Research project exploring the value of co-design in different cultural contexts, including participatory design sprints in Spain and the Netherlands